

mass extinction Death of a large number of dinosaur, animal, or plant species at the same time

Mesozoic Era Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous periods together

meteorite Rock from space that crashes into Earth

omnivore Animal that eats both plant matter and meat

ornithomimids Plant-eating dinosaurs that stood on two legs. They lived in the Jurassic and Cretaceous periods

pachycephalosaurs Plant-eating or omnivorous dinosaurs with two legs and domed skulls. They lived in the Cretaceous period

paleontologist Scientist who studies fossilized finds, including dinosaurs, animals, and plants

Pangaea Huge supercontinent that existed on Earth at the start of the Mesozoic Era

plesiosaur Type of marine reptile that usually had a long neck, alive in the Mesozoic Era

predator Dinosaur or other animal that hunts other living animals for food

prehistoric Ancient time before recorded history

preserved Remains that have not changed much over time

prey Dinosaur or other animal that is hunted for food

primate Group of mammals that includes monkeys, apes, and humans

pterosaurs Large, flying reptiles of the Mesozoic Era

reptiles Cold-blooded animals with scaly skin that reproduce by laying eggs. This group includes snakes, lizards, crocodiles, and dinosaurs

sauropods Huge plant-eating dinosaurs on four legs with long necks and small heads. They lived in the Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous periods

scavenger Dinosaur or other animal that feeds on the leftover meat of another animal that has already died, whether by a predator attack or natural causes

serrated Having a sharp, jagged edge

solitary An animal that lives alone

species Specific types of dinosaurs, animals, or plants with shared features that can mate and produce young together

stegosaurs Plant-eating dinosaurs with four legs and plates or spines down their backs. They lived in the Jurassic and Cretaceous periods

theropods Meat-eating dinosaurs that hunted on two legs. They lived in the Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous periods, and were the ancestors of birds

Triassic period First of three periods in the Mesozoic Era, from 252 to 201 million years ago

vegetation Plant life found in a particular habitat

vertebrate Animal with a backbone